2005 Honda Accord LX

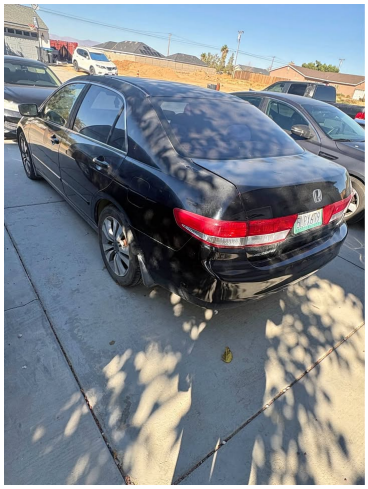
$3,000 · 220,000 miles · Private seller · California City, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

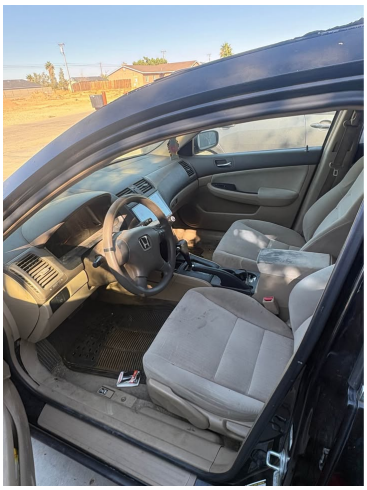
Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/1150594717632968/

Report generated October 29, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$3,452	**$397**	**Good**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	4/5 · 24 recalls · 686 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$3,000.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$277.50
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$19.50
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$32.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$3,452.00
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$3,452.00
Amount financed	$0.00
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$3,602.00

Paid in full with your down payment — no loan needed.

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$0.00
Insurance (estimate, liability)	$70.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 24 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$197.92
Maintenance & repair reserve	$115.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$14.12
Total per month	$397.04

Running costs without the loan: **$397/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$8,366** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **liability coverage** estimate ($70/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Good (4/5)

Good model with the 4-cylinder (2.4L K24 is very durable). But this car has 220k miles, and the 2005 Accord has 24 recalls - mostly Takata airbag inflators, which are dangerous if not replaced.

NHTSA data for this model year: 24 recalls · 686 owner complaints (96 involving a crash). Most complaints: Air Bags (226), Power Train (114), Electrical System (99), Vehicle Speed Control (59), Service Brakes (53), Steering (42).

Known issues for this model

• Takata airbag inflators (multiple recalls) - can rupture and spray metal

• Automatic transmission software/secondary shaft recall (4-cyl 2005-2010)

• V6 automatics in this generation fail often (avoid V6)

• Power steering pump leaks/whine

• Door lock actuators, A/C compressor clutch

• 220k miles = wear items everywhere

Check on this car before buying

• Confirm 4-cylinder

• Run VIN: Takata airbag recalls MUST be completed

• Seller must provide smog cert (listing says 'needs smog')

• Test shifting: no flare/slip between gears

• Look for oil leaks, check suspension bushings

Notes

$3,000 negotiable, 220k, automatic, black/tan. Clean title, tags paid, CarPlay installed.

Says 'needs a smog' - in CA the SELLER must provide a passing smog cert. Don't buy until it passes.

Budget backup. Confirm 4-cyl (V6 auto in this gen has weak transmissions). Very high miles.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.